Level 4 – Transmutation
Casting Time: Action · Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S, M (a caterpillar cocoon) · Duration: Concentration, up to 1 hour
Classes: Bard, Druid, Sorcerer, Wizard

Choose a creature you can see within range. If it is unwilling, it makes a **Wisdom saving throw** to resist. The spell has no effect on a **Shapechanger** or a creature with 0 Hit Points.

The target transforms into a **Beast** of your choice whose Challenge Rating isn't higher than its own (or its level if it has no CR). Its statistics are replaced by the Beast's; it keeps its alignment and personality.

The target gains **Temporary Hit Points** equal to the Beast's HP. The spell ends if it has none left. It can't speak, cast spells, or take actions outside its form's capabilities. Its gear melds into the new form.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. You choose a visible creature within 60 ft.
2. If unwilling: Wisdom save.
3. It becomes a Beast of equal or lower CR.
4. It gains the Beast's Temporary HP; at 0, the form ends.

⚠ Change from 2014

In 2014, the target took the Beast's HP and returned to its original HP. In 2024, it gains **Temporary Hit Points** equal to the Beast's.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The text leaves the Beast choice to the DM within a CR limit. Fix: announce before the game which Beasts are allowed.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe a twisting body, cracking bones, a new silhouette rising.

Step 1 – Choose the target:

A visible creature within 60 ft: willing, or a Wisdom save to resist.

Step 2 – Choose the Beast:

A Beast whose CR is equal to or lower than the target's (or its level).

Step 3 – Transformation:

The Beast's statistics replace the target's. It keeps alignment and personality, and gains Temporary HP.

Step 4 – End of the spell:

The form ends at the end of the duration, if concentration breaks, or when Temporary HP drop to 0.

Example: Maëlle turns Hugo (level 5) into a brown bear (CR 1). Hugo gains the bear's Temporary HP. When they drop to 0, the form ends.

POLYMORPH (5E, 2024 RULES) – Q&A AND DEBATE

⚠ Common questions:

How long does it last?
Concentration, up to 1 hour.

Which save?
Wisdom, if the target is unwilling.

What happens at 0 Temporary HP?
The spell ends on the target.

Can the target speak?
No, nor cast spells.

Does it keep its items?
They meld into its new form and can't be used.

Does it keep its personality?
Yes, alignment and personality.

Does it work on a Shapechanger?
No.

Can I choose any Beast?
A Beast of equal or lower CR than the target.
Table rule

⚠ Debate points and table options:
Table rule

Choice of Beast
A Beast stat block from the SRD is needed.
Option: a list of allowed Beasts, announced before the game.

Willing target
A willing ally makes no save. **Option**: keep it.

Gear
Gear melds and can't be used. **Option**: follow the text.

Concentration
If the caster loses concentration, the form ends.
Option: keep it.

Power
A high-CR Beast can outclass a character.
Option: cap CR at a table threshold.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Concentration while transformed
You can't cast new spells while transformed, but you keep concentrating on a spell cast before.

Mental ability scores
A willing target also takes the new form's mental ability scores.

Reverting
Leftover damage is subject to the true form's Resistances.

Other spell effects
Polymorph replaces only the stat block: other spell effects on the creature remain.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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